

Feature ideas from learning-platform research

Prepared 7 October 2026 · 26 ideas in 7 themes · status notes reflect the build as of the same day

These ideas come from studying how established learning platforms keep learners engaged, then fitting each one to what this platform already does. That covers the setup questions that adapt the course, the method behind every module, the workflow diagrams, the tutor and the learning plan.

Platforms studied: Duolingo, Coursera Coach, Khan Academy and Khanmigo, Brilliant, DataCamp, Codecademy, Scrimba, Exercism, Sololearn, LinkedIn Learning and Udemy Role Play, Maven cohorts, n8n Academy, Google Learn Your Way, NotebookLM, plus research on spaced repetition (the FSRS scheduler), the hypercorrection effect and Open Badges 3.0.

House rules every idea keeps: no leaderboards, no invented numbers, a static version under reduced motion, and every string in the English messages file.

S about half a day **M** one to two days **L** three days or more

UI-only works now with browser storage and fixtures **Backend** needs a server

Today: partly built since the ideas were written

A. Personalisation, building on the setup

01 Skip-ahead check

M

UI-only

Khan Academy course challenge, n8n Academy quickstart

After setup, an optional five-question check. Lessons the learner already knows get a "you know this" badge, and they can go straight to the final check.

Today: a 12-question quick check runs at enrolment and sets the help in each lesson. It does not let learners skip lessons yet.

02 My automation idea

S

UI-only

Coursera Coach career goals, Learn Your Way interests

The learner describes one manual task they want to automate. Lessons and the capstone brief then refer to it, for example "your weekly invoice export".

03 Time-back calculator

S

UI-only

Minutes per run and runs per week give hours back per year for the learner's own task, labelled as their estimate. Pairs with idea 2.

04 "Simpler / more technical" toggle on explanations

S

UI-only, two levels

Learn Your Way re-leveilling

Swaps between the main explanation and the alternative one already in the content. A real third version needs authored text or a model.

05 Listen mode

SUI-only

NotebookLM audio overviews, Learn Your Way audio lessons

A play button reads the narration aloud, highlighting the current sentence. Good for commutes and accessibility.

Today: every module's concept topic is now a narrated slide video with a recorded voice, captions and speed control. Other topics are not read aloud yet.

06 Pace check-in after Module 1

SUI-only

Two quick questions, "too fast / right / too slow" and "time per session", adjust the support level and the plan's session length.

Today: study days and session length are set on the Customise screen at enrolment. There is no check-in after Module 1 yet.

B. Learning by doing

07 Edit the run

MUI-only

Scrimba pause-and-edit screencasts, Brilliant interactive problems

In a worked example, pause the run, change a node such as a filter condition, and run it again to watch different items flow through. Needs a small mock runner over sample rows.

08 Playground page

LUI-only

DataCamp Workspace, n8n Academy practice APIs, Sololearn code playground

Free building on a canvas with the node palette and sample data, with no grading. Reuses the guided-build pieces.

09 Bug hunts

MUI-only

A broken workflow and an error log; find and fix the fault, like the 2:07 AM incident. Doubles as practice for the final check and fits the reliability module.

10 Confidence check

SUI-only

Research on the hypercorrection effect

Before submitting an answer, the learner taps how sure they are. Confident errors get stronger feedback, and the dashboard shows how well confidence matches results.

C. AI tutor upgrades

11 Socratic tutor mode

MModel for full version

Khanmigo, Coursera Coach Dialogues

The tutor asks a guiding question before giving the answer, with a choice of hint, nudge or full answer. Scripted from the content first.

12 Role-play

M

Model for free conversation

LinkedIn Learning and Udemy AI Role Play, Duolingo Video Call

A short scripted chat: explain the outage to Ana the founder, or pitch an automation to a manager. The persona follows the learner's role from setup.

13 Ask the course

S

UI-only

Coursera Coach, NotebookLM questions over sources

Search the lesson notes from the Ctrl+K menu ("where did we cover pagination?") and jump to that exact point.

Today: the tutor now answers from the video narration and cites the lesson and slide. Ctrl+K search over lessons is not built yet.

D. Retention and habit, without guilt

14 Memory strength per concept

M

UI-only, approximate

FSRS and Anki, Duolingo practice hub

Each concept (Trigger, Item, Filter and so on) shows as strong, fading or due, with one "Practise fading ideas" button.

15 Planned-days streak

S

UI-only

Duolingo and Sololearn streaks, made gentler

Counts the study days the learner planned and kept, not every calendar day. Rest days never break it.

16 Reminders where you work

S

Backend to deliver

Slack and Teams microlearning (Arist)

Settings to receive the planned session and a two-minute review card by email, Slack or Teams, with a preview of the message.

17 Weekly recap

S

UI-only

A short "this week" story: topics finished, ideas reviewed, the workflow built and hours back on the learner's own task. Shareable.

E. Mastery and proof

18 Skills map with mastery levels

M

UI-only

Khan Academy: Attempted, Familiar, Proficient, Mastered

Each course objective gets a level fed by checks, the final check and recall checks, shown on the dashboard and course page.

19 Portfolio and "Take it to n8n"

M

UI-only

Codecademy portfolio projects, the prototype's Portfolio page

Each workflow the learner builds becomes a portfolio card with its checks and a JSON download they can import into n8n.

Today: the wrap-up lists what the learner built. There is no portfolio page or n8n export yet.

20 Verifiable badges

S

Backend to sign

Open Badges 3.0, n8n Academy verifiable badges

An add-to-LinkedIn button and a public verify page.

Today: a course credential is issued at the wrap-up and shown on the Credentials page. It is not signed, and there is no LinkedIn button yet.

F. Community (needs a backend)

21 Workflow review requests

L

Exercism mentoring, Coursera peer review

Submit the capstone for review against a rubric.

22 Cohort mode

L

Maven

A start date, a weekly live session and a discussion thread per module.

23 Questions others asked here

M

Anonymised questions and answers anchored to each lesson point.

24 Showcase by field

M

A gallery of learner workflows, filtered by Manufacturing, Retail and other fields.

G. Convenience

25 Notes and highlights

M

UI-only

NotebookLM study guides

Highlight lesson text, keep it in a notebook, and turn highlights into review cards.

26 Bilingual glossary

S

UI-only

Hover a key term such as Trigger to see its definition in English and Hindi, a language the course already lists.

Deliberately left out

- **Leaderboards and leagues.** The course design framework warns that extrinsic rewards crowd out motivation.
- **Hearts and lives limits.** They punish mistakes, which conflicts with treating errors as part of learning.

Recommended first batch

Five ideas that are distinctive, backed by learning research, buildable without a backend, and that extend existing code. They are still open.

1. Confidence check (idea 10)

A three-step "how sure are you?" control on lesson checks and the final check. Confident wrong answers get stronger feedback, and the dashboard shows calibration.

2. Skills map with mastery levels (idea 18)

A level per objective from the final check, lesson checks and recall checks, on the dashboard and the course page's Outcomes section.

3. Edit the run (idea 7)

After a worked example runs, change a filter condition or mapped field and re-run the same diagram, with items in and out per node.

4. My automation idea and time-back calculator (ideas 2 and 3)

An optional card on the course page and dashboard. Hours per year are labelled as the learner's estimate and referenced in the capstone brief.

5. Listen mode (idea 5)

Now partly covered by the narrated concept videos. The remaining work is reading the other topics aloud.

Sources

1. Duolingo gamification and retention: strivecloud.io
2. Duolingo Max, Explain My Answer and Video Call: blog.duolingo.com
3. Coursera Coach for educators (Coach Dialogues): blog.coursera.org
4. Coursera AI grading in peer reviews: blog.coursera.org
5. Khanmigo Socratic tutoring: cut-the-saas.com
6. Khan Academy mastery levels: support.khanacademy.org
7. Brilliant, learn by doing: apps.apple.com
8. Scrimba interactive screencasts: survivejs.com
9. Exercism mentoring: xebia.com
10. DataCamp Workspace: datacamp.com
11. Codecademy features: todaytesting.com
12. n8n Academy launch: community.n8n.io
13. LinkedIn Learning AI role play: hr.arizona.edu
14. Udemy Role Play expansion: cxodigitalpulse.com
15. Maven cohort review: skillscouter.com
16. Google Learn Your Way: research.google
17. NotebookLM features: cyfuture.cloud
18. FSRS compared with SM-2: diane.app
19. Hypercorrection effect: pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov
20. Confidence scores and learning: eedi.substack.com
21. Open Badges 3.0: pok.tech
22. Learning in the flow of work: arist.com

